

```
start_handler = CommandHandler('start',
start)
```

Note. You can see the source code for the Dispatcher class in the file dispatcher.py at <https://github.com/python-telegram-bot/python-telegram-bot/blob/7b3b278c7c09d2961a696e58b955914486d96313/telegram/ext/dispatcher.py>

Having created an object of type *CommandHandler*, you can add it to the *Dispatcher* class object (which in our code is *my_dispatcher*), using the method *add_handler()* of the *Dispatcher* class. So, the code will be as follows:

```
1 from telegram.ext import Updater,
CommandHandler
2 my_updater = Updater(token='Your_
token_here', use_context=True)
3 my_dispatcher = my_updater.dispatcher
4
5 def start(update, context):
6 chat_id = update.effective_chat.id # Get
id of the chat.
7 f_name = update.effective_chat.first_name
# First name of bot user
8 l_name = update.effective_chat.last_name
# Last name of bot user
```

```
9 full_name = f_name + ' ' + l_name # Full
name of bot user
10 out_text = 'Hi {0} {1} from bot'.
format(f_name, l_name)
11 # The print functions are to show the
contents of the variables
12 # You can remove the print functions
13 print(update)
14 print('effective_chat ->', update.
effective_chat)
15 print('chat_id->', chat_id)
16 print('bot->', context.bot)
17
18 my_bot = context.bot # my_bot is an
object of type telegram.Bot
19 # print(my_bot)
20 my_bot.send_message(chat_id, text=
out_text)
21 start_handler = CommandHandler('start',
start)
22 my_dispatcher.add_handler(start_
handler)
23 # my_updater.start_polling() starts the
bot, and the bot begins
24 # to start polling Telegram for any chat
updates.
25 # The bot has its own separate threads so
it wont halt your Python script.
26 my_updater.start_polling()
```

```
27 # my_updater.idle() command is used to
block the script until
28 # the user sends a command to break from
the Python script such as ctrl-c
29 on windows
30 my_updater.idle()
```

The complete code for this bot is available on GitHub at https://github.com/ag999git/jupyter_notebooks/blob/master/telegram-bot

Further extensions

You can improvise and extend the functionality of the bot. This bot accepts only one command, namely, */start*. You can create a message handler. For that you will need an object of class *MessageHandler*. You can also try using *Webhooks* or install your bot on a remote server like Heroku, PythonAnywhere, etc. **EFY**

This article was first published in August 2020 issue of Open Source For You

Anurag Gupta is an engineer by education but a police officer by profession. He is a Python enthusiast who has recently co-authored a book on Python named *Python Programming: Problem Solving, Packages and Libraries*

What's New In Electronics & IoT During These Challenging Times?

Visit 'Online Only' expo-cum-conference from anywhere, any time.

 **TechWorldCongress**
@Home 2021

MONTHLY EVENT. FREE ENTRY. REGISTER NOW.

 | TechWorldCongress.com